



HEDEBY

GERMANY



SICILY

ITALY

POST CARD

Today: Hedeby – barely a Hedeby left to stand in, just a green ring of earthworks where the ramparts ran. From here I'm turning south: nothing but Mediterranean weather for the rest of this trip.

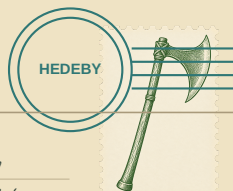
A woodcarver at the reconstruction huts showed me how the old branch-runes worked – count the branches one way for the family, the other way for the letter. I copied his Key out for you before I forgot it.

Love,
Aunt Liv

his Key, copied out:

1 – f u þ ö r k
2 – h n i a s
3 – t b m l r

(left branches = which row. right = where in it.)



TO

John Ericson

24 Longship Way

Ottawa ON K1L 1S1

Canada

FUN FACT

In 1050, during his war with Denmark, Harald burned Hedeby to the ground — sailing burning ships straight into the harbour. Archaeologists later found their charred timbers still lying in the Schlei.

Image adaptation: "Hedeby, Busdorf (P1100664)" - Matti Blume, CC BY-SA 4.0.

POST CARD

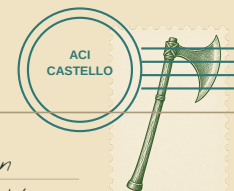
Aci Castello today.

A Norman Castle in Sicily! It's crazy to think how far they travelled!

Being a good tourist, I enjoyed a gelato while walking around the ruins. Little did I know, that is a great way to attract wildlife. A raven followed me the whole time!

Half convinced it was you, checking up on me.

Love,
Aunt Liv



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FUN FACT

Aci Castello's rock is over 500,000 years old — lava that cooled underwater into a mass of glassy basalt pillars. The castle itself later spent three centuries as a prison, until an 1818 earthquake made it too unsafe to hold anyone.

Image adaptation: "Acicastello - Castello Normanno" - Pannuccis, CC BY-SA 4.0.